



The Batman resumes filming

More plot details revealed, as set photos from Matt Reeves' The Batman surfaces online.
<http://digit.in/nov20-41>



Jared Leto to return as Joker

Jared Leto will be reprising his role as the Joker in Zack Snyder's Justice League.
<http://digit.in/nov20-42>

Movie Reviews In Traditional Media

Talk about the movie
for crying out loud!

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eing a movie lover is fun. And right now, is a good time to be one too. There is just a wide array of content

for one to explore and consume.

However, at times, looking at the trailer or promotional material for a film, one might feel a tad bit indecisive about watching it. So, you resort to checking out movie reviews online, in the hopes of getting a better picture. Sadly, you do not. In fact, after having read through some of them, you end up with a much more hollow, inconclusive feeling about the film than before. This is extremely common, and generally has to do with the most basic fact, that these so-called "movie reviews" barely ever talk about the freaking movie!



Credit: Taxi Driver (1976), Columbia Pictures

Now, try not to act all clueless when I say this. But most of these reviews that you see in traditional media have a way of working your mind. We have all been through this. You look at this sort of "exquisite", pretentious, Elizabethan era writing and instantly get sucked into it. But upon reading, it

almost feels like deep poetry, instead of a movie review. You encounter the usual culprits - long sentences overloaded with adjectives, metaphorical writing and references, and whining about complexities. I mean, it does make a lot of sense considering most of

these reviewers are actually just a bunch of mass-media graduate poets, under a guise. Now, there is nothing awfully wrong about poetic expression. The issue arises, when a critic chooses to be poetic, at the expense of actually "reviewing" the film. You know, details regarding the setting and pacing, the performances from the actors, the positives and negatives, interpretations, stuff like that. Instead, what you get is a well-written English essay, that smooth talks its way through your mind, leaving you all the more confused. Part of the problem lies in the fact that usually, the writing itself is difficult to understand. And even then, they only seem to vaguely describe an aspect of a film, despite preaching about it for lengths. It is amusing to me as to how rigid these critics are in terms of their word choices. Like they are trying to one-up themselves each time, with their genius-level intellect in literature! So, instead of describing an element in simple terms, they choose to use absurd, posh adjectives like "tawdry" and "poignant" to get their point across. Most of the time, they are just being used as filler words. How much are you willing to bet, that the person reading, even knows what those, or similarly-fashioned words mean? All they wanted was some context before

getting into the film. And here you are, with tea cups in your hands!

There are times when I have come across reviews, where the writer chooses to stall a bit. Luckily enough, these are the ones where they actually talk about the film; to an extent. By the time you are finished reading one of these reviews, you realise that only one-third of the text had anything to do with the movie. Everything else is just irrelevant details, which could range from personal political opinions to something as bizarre as one's sexual fantasies upon seeing an actor! They treat it as a personal diary almost. A



Credit: TENET, Warner Bros. Pictures

recurring theme to be seen with most, recent movie reviews is, milking the topic - "Theatres shutting down due to the pandemic". Where for some reason, you see one giant paragraph talking about it and stalling basically. The lockdown was initiated seven months ago! Unless you are talking about Christopher

Nolan's TENET, which released in theatres, during the pandemic, how is that even remotely relevant to the subject at hand?!

Sometimes, the reviews just seem biased. And yes, I am very well aware that it all boils down to personal opinion. But what bugs me, is the way these critics oversell or undersell a film. A good chunk of it has to do with the previously mentioned poetic writing, due to which the expressions feel exaggerated to the highest degree. So, a personal opinion, feels more like a projection. Plus, a lot of the praise or criticism seems to align with their genre preference, feelings or political views, rather than the film, by itself. Adding onto it is the occasional hypocrisy. Where they basically whine about the long runtime, and how complex or artsy a film is, while themselves writing "pristine" English assignments that barely make any sense. 